

Continuing work on another laptop

A short checklist for picking this project back up on a different machine — git specifics, environment setup, and where to find "what's done, what's next." For the full local run instructions, see `README.md`'s "Running it" section — this handbook only covers what's different about a second machine.

1 GET THE CODE

```
git clone https://github.com/arihantjaino7/sentinels.git
cd sentinels
git checkout master
```

Important — the branch you want is `master`, not `main`. GitHub's default branch on this repo is `main`, so a plain `git clone` checks out `main` by default — that branch is old and doesn't have any of the v2/v3 work. All real development lives on `master`. There's also a third branch, `github-release`, which is unrelated and can be ignored.

If you already have a clone from before, just:

```
git checkout master
git pull
```

2 RECREATE THE ENVIRONMENT SECRETS

`.env` files are gitignored on purpose — they never get committed, so they don't exist on a fresh clone. Recreate `backend/.env` by copying the example and filling in your own key directly in the file, not in chat (a Groq key has leaked into a commit before by being pasted where it shouldn't have been — see `docs/ACTIVITY_LOG.md` around 2026-07-30):

```
cd backend
cp .env.example .env
# open .env and paste GROQ_API_KEY=... yourself
```

This is optional — the app runs fully without it, just without the AI summary (per `CLAUDE.md`'s AI-is-optional guarantee).

3 INSTALL AND RUN

Follow `README.md`'s "Running it" section exactly — `backend venv + pip install + playwright install chromium`, `frontend npm install`. Nothing about that differs machine to machine.

4 FIND OUT WHERE THINGS STAND

- **`docs/PLAN-v3.md`** — the status line at the very top says exactly what phase/milestone is done and what's next. This is the first thing to read. As of this handbook update: Phases R-A through R-D (R11) are all done — live URL

scans and GitHub repo scans both work end-to-end, streaming progress included. Only **R12** (the file-tree browser) is left.

- **docs/learning/** — every concept, numbered in the order it was built (currently up to 45). Read in order the first time; use as reference after.
- **docs/ROADMAP.md** / **docs/PLAN-v2.md** — the original v1 and v2 build plans, both fully shipped; kept for history.

5 KEEP BOTH MACHINES IN SYNC

- **Before starting work**, always `git pull` first, so you're not building on top of a stale copy.
- **Commit and push in reasonably small chunks** rather than hoarding a huge uncommitted diff — the whole point of pushing is that the other laptop can pick up mid-stream.
- **Never force-push** `master` (`git push --force`) unless you know exactly why — it can overwrite work sitting on the other machine that you haven't pulled down yet.
- If both machines somehow end up with unpushed commits at once, `git pull` will ask you to merge (or rebase) — resolve that before pushing, don't discard either side blindly.

6 STARTING A NEW SESSION

Just say what you want to work on, or say "start R12" / whatever the next milestone in `docs/PLAN-v3.md` is — that file has enough context (what's done, what's next, and any design decisions already made) to pick up directly without re-explaining the whole project. Right now that's **R12, the file-tree browser** — the last milestone in the v3 plan.

7 A REAL GOTCHA WORTH KNOWING

If a live scan in the browser ever fails with **"Inspection failed — Lost connection to the scanner"**, don't assume the code is broken — check whether the backend on port 8000 is actually serving current code first:

```
curl http://localhost:8000/repo/agents
```

If that 404s, the process listening on port 8000 is stale (running old code from before a restart) or something else already holds that port. On Windows, if `Get-Process -Id (Get-NetTCPConnection -LocalPort 8000 -State Listen).OwningProcess` can't find the PID it just reported — a real, reproducible quirk hit while building R11 — stop trying to kill it and just run the backend on a different port instead (`--port 8010`), then point the frontend at it via `frontend/.env.local`:

```
NEXT_PUBLIC_API_BASE=http://localhost:8010
```

Restart the frontend dev server (not just a page refresh) after adding that file.